

Spin-Polarization Control of Photoelectrons Using Poincaré Fields

(Extra notes)

Constants

- The normalized field amplitude tells the strength of the field relative to the electron rest energy

$$a_0 = \frac{eE}{m_e c \omega} \quad (1)$$

- Keldysh parameter tells the regime, tunnel or multiphoton

$$\gamma = \frac{\omega}{E} \sqrt{2m_e I_p} = \sqrt{\frac{2I_p}{m_e a_0^2 c}} \quad (2)$$

- The ionization potential

$$I_p = m_e c^2 - E, \quad \text{with} \quad E = m_e c^2 \sqrt{1 - (Z\alpha)^2} \quad (3)$$

if $Z\alpha \ll 1$, (nonrelativistic case),

$$I_p \sim \frac{m_e Z \alpha^2 c}{2} \quad (4)$$

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Vector spherical harmonics and the magnetic multipole field

- The multipole order electromagnetic field is written, the poles being magnetic

$$\mathbf{A}_{jm}(\mathbf{k}, t) = \text{Re } A_0 \mathbf{\Phi}_{jm}(\theta_{\mathbf{k}}, \varphi_{\mathbf{k}}) \delta(|\mathbf{k}| - \omega) e^{i\omega t}, \quad (5)$$

$$\mathbf{A}_{jm}(\mathbf{r}, t) = \text{Re } A_0 g_j(kr) \mathbf{\Phi}_{jm}(\theta, \varphi) e^{i\omega t}, \quad (6)$$

where $\mathbf{\Phi}_{jm}(\theta, \varphi) = \hat{\mathbf{r}} \times \nabla Y_{jm}(\theta, \varphi)$ and $g_j(z) = \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{2z}} J_{j+1/2}(z)$ is the Bessel function of the first kind

$$j \geq 1, \quad |m| < j - 1 \quad (7)$$

j	m	Structure	Interpretation
1	0	(dipole) Simplest radiative field	Common in laser, no azimuthal twist, linear polarized dipole.
2	± 1	(quadrupole) Four-lobbed pattern	Forbidden transitions, nuclear EM fields, Circular polariz., spin angular moment.
3	± 2	(octupole) Eight-lobbed pattern	High energy transit., structured beams, nontrivial orbital structure
4+	± 3	Higher multipoles	HHG, nuclear EM moments, astrophysics, high order vortex beams etc..

- j is used not as the sum of ℓ and spin s , but rather as a convention.
- Notice that the inequality (7) is strict

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Calculation of helicity

- Using the metric $(+, -, -, -)$ and having σ as the Pauli matrices

$$\gamma^0 \equiv \beta = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbb{1} & 0 \\ 0 & -\mathbb{1} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \gamma = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \sigma \\ -\sigma & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \alpha = \gamma^0 \gamma, \quad \Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} \sigma & 0 \\ 0 & \sigma \end{pmatrix}. \quad (8)$$

- The helicity of the particle is the projection of its spin along $\mathbf{n} = \mathbf{p}/|\mathbf{p}|$ and is a "good quantum number"
- Helicity density is expressed as

$$\zeta(\mathbf{p}) = \langle \tilde{\psi}(\mathbf{p}) | \left(\mathbf{n} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \Sigma \right) | \tilde{\psi}(\mathbf{p}) \rangle, \quad \mathbf{n} = (\sin \theta \sin \varphi, \sin \theta \cos \varphi, \cos \varphi), \quad (9)$$

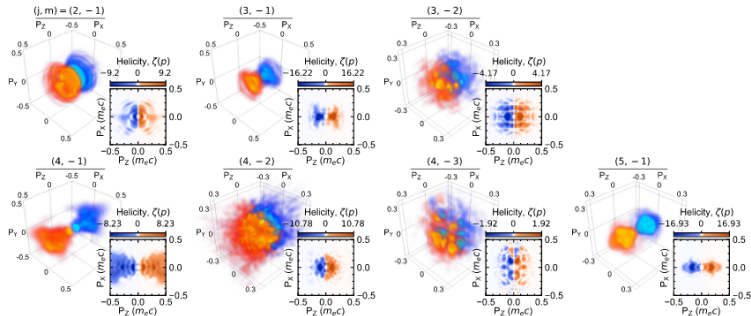
$$\zeta(\mathbf{p}) = \frac{1}{2} \int d^3 \mathbf{p} \tilde{\psi}^*(\mathbf{p}) \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & \sin \theta e^{-i\varphi} & 0 & 0 \\ \sin \theta e^{i\varphi} & -\cos \theta & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cos \theta & \sin \theta e^{-i\varphi} \\ 0 & 0 & \sin \theta e^{i\varphi} & -\cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \tilde{\psi}(\mathbf{p}) \quad (10)$$

- The case of a free electron in its $\gamma = +1/2$ helicity state is in the supp. materials

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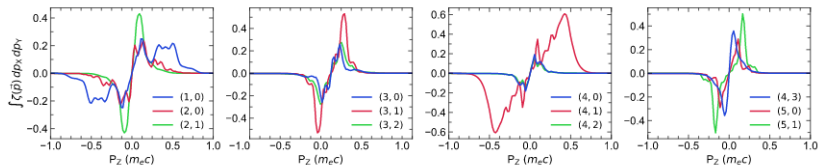
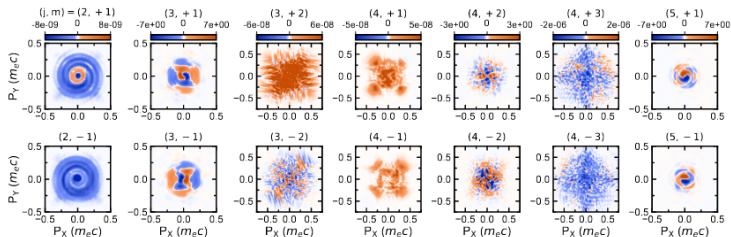
Helicity density $\zeta(p)$ of Ne^{9+} - Single mode ionization case - ($m < 0$)



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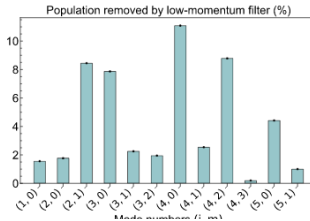
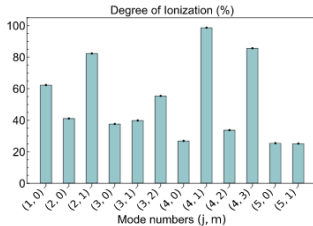
Helicity density $\zeta(p)$ of Ne^{9+} - Single mode ionization case - Integrated



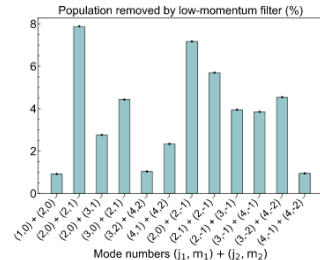
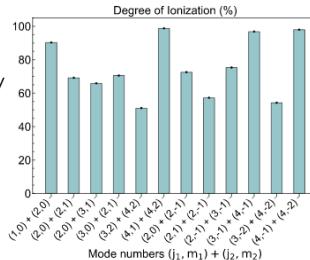
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Visual effect of the mask function $\mathcal{M}_\mu(\mathbf{r})$



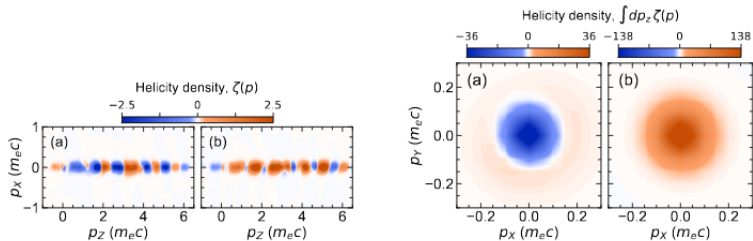
- Left : Degree of ionization for each mode, bound population was removed by using $\mathcal{M}_\mu(\mathbf{r})$
- Right : Percent of the population removed by the low momentum filter $\mathcal{M}_\mu(\mathbf{p})$



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Helicity density $\zeta(p)$ of Ar^{17+}



- Irradiation by a left-(a) and right-(b) -circularly-polarized field
- Leftmost panels : Distribution in the xy -plane
- Rightmost panels : Distribution integrated along the z momentum direction